

LEARNING INTENTION

I can explain how adaptations help living things survive in their habitats.

SUCCESS CRITERIA

- ☐ I can define structural and behavioural adaptations
- ☐ I can match adaptations to specific habitats
- ☐ I can explain WHY an adaptation helps survival

KEY CONCEPTS

Structural adaptation: a physical body feature (e.g. thick fur, sharp claws). **Behavioural adaptation:** something an animal does (e.g. hibernating, migrating).

WORKED EXAMPLE

The thorny devil lizard has scales that channel water to its mouth. This **structural** adaptation helps it survive in Australia's dry desert by collecting dew.

PART A — WARM UP

1. What is a structural adaptation? Give one example.
2. What is a behavioural adaptation? Give one example.
3. A penguin has a thick layer of blubber under its skin. Is this structural or behavioural?
4. Name one Australian animal and one adaptation it has.

PART B — CORE SKILLS

5. Match the adaptation to its habitat:
webbed feet → ____; thick fur → ____; large ears → ____
6. A red kangaroo avoids heat by resting in the shade during the day. Is this structural or behavioural? Explain.
7. Why does a stick insect look like a twig? Explain how this helps its survival.
8. Name ONE structural and ONE behavioural adaptation of a platypus.

SCIENCE HELPER

Habitat = the natural environment where an organism lives. **Adaptation** = a feature or behaviour developed over time that increases survival. Always link adaptations to the specific challenges of the habitat (e.g. temperature, water availability, predators).

WORKING SPACE — DIAGRAMS, NOTES AND LABELLING

PART C — CHALLENGE

9. Real-World Context: The bilby is a native Australian marsupial that lives in arid desert regions. It has large ears, powerful digging claws and is nocturnal (active at night). Explain how each of these three features helps the bilby survive in its habitat.

10. Reasoning: If an environment suddenly changed (e.g. a forest became a dry grassland), predict what would happen to an animal that could not adapt, and one that could. Use scientific language in your answer.

REFLECTION

Today I learned...

I CAN CHECKLIST

- ☐ I can define structural/behavioural adaptations
- ☐ I can match adaptations to habitats
- ☐ I can explain WHY adaptations aid survival

TEACHER FEEDBACK

Strength: _____

Next Step: _____

PARENT TIP

Visit a zoo or wildlife park and spot adaptations — ask "why does it look like that?"

TEACHER TIP

Use Australian animals as primary examples — stronger curriculum relevance and student engagement.

ANSWER KEY (FOR PARENT / TEACHER USE)

Q1: Physical body feature, e.g. sharp claws, thick fur, camouflage colouring

Q2: Something an animal does, e.g. hibernating, migrating, nocturnal activity

Q3: Structural (physical body layer)

Q4: Accept any correct Australian animal and matching adaptation

Q5: Webbed feet → water/wetland; thick fur → cold/polar; large ears → desert (heat release)

Q6: Behavioural — resting is an action, not a physical feature

Q7: Camouflage — blends in with twigs so predators can't see it

Q8: Structural: waterproof fur / bill; Behavioural: hunting at night

Q9: Large ears → release body heat; claws → dig burrows to escape heat; nocturnal → avoids daytime heat and predators

Q10: Accept reasoned answer — animal unable to adapt may face extinction; one that can will continue to survive and reproduce